
A GUIDE BY TARAN AUJLA

The Rebuild.

Notes on escaping autopilot.

How I rebuilt my body, my health,
and my mind in under a year.

ONE.

WHAT THIS IS

This is a guide about a personal rebuild. Mine. From a body that was failing, a mind that was running on autopilot, and a life that looked fine on the outside while quietly falling apart underneath, to a different version of all three in under a year.

It is not a fitness program. It is not a meditation course. It is not a self-help system. It is what I actually did, in the order I did it, when I stopped pretending the version of life I was running was working.

What you will get in the next twenty pages is the shift that produced the result. The principle. The practices. The protocols. The honest pace. And the proof, documented in medical records anyone can verify.

The whole thing rests on one idea. The mind goes first. The body follows. The life follows after that. Reversing the order is why most people try to change something about themselves and end up exactly where they started six months later.

If you have been running on autopilot for years, ignoring what your body has been telling you, telling yourself you will deal with it next month, this is what worked when nothing else did.

One day at a time.

TWO.

WHO THIS IS FOR

This is for the man who has been functioning on the surface while quietly aware that something underneath is no longer working. The body is heavier than it should be. The mind is louder than it used to be. The energy is gone by 3pm. The sleep is not real sleep. The medications keep stacking up. The patterns he runs on do not feel like discipline anymore. They feel like maintenance of a version of himself he no longer wants to be.

He has tried the standard moves. The diet. The gym. The trainer. The productivity stack. The morning routine. The supplement protocol. Some of it stuck for a few weeks. None of it produced what he was actually looking for, which was a different version of the man underneath, not a different version of his to-do list.

This is for that man.

It is not for someone who needs a different macros calculation or a better workout plan. It is for the man who has done all that and is still looking for the lever that actually moves things.

I am not a coach. I am not a fitness guru. I am a man who spent more than a decade running on autopilot, on five medications he should not have needed, with a body operating like someone twice his age, and a mind that had stopped questioning any of it. In under a year, all of that turned around. The weight came off. The medications stopped. The bloodwork normalized. The way I think shifted. I have not looked back.

This is what worked.

THREE.

MY PROOF

Before we go further, the proof. The reason this guide is worth your time is that the result is real, dated, and documented. Every number below is from lab work in named clinics, signed by named physicians, with the records to back it up.

January 2025 to Spring 2026. About sixteen months.

	January 2025	Spring 2026
Weight	221 lbs (BMI 35, obese)	150 lbs (normal weight)
Liver	Stage 4 fibrosis	Stage 0 (completely reversed)
GGT	1,285 (21x upper limit)	23 (deep normal)
Cholesterol	10.14	4.65
Triglycerides	4.23	0.74
Blood pressure	160/100	134/77
Medications	Five daily	Zero, confirmed by physician

THE SAME PERSON.

Before and after.



January 2025 to Spring 2026. The same person, sixteen months apart.

The records are on my personal site at taranaujla.ca. You can review them. You can write to me through the site if you want to verify any of it.

Most transformation content has a story but not the markers. The visual change is easy to fake. The bloodwork is not. The liver fibrosis reversal is not. The medication elimination is not. That distinction matters. The thing I am about to teach you produced a real, measurable, medically documented rebuild.

FOUR.

WHERE I WAS

For most of the decade before the rebuild, I was running on autopilot. I worked at a level most people would call successful. I showed up. I kept the obligations. From the outside, things tracked.

Underneath, I had stopped paying attention. The body was sending signals for years and I was overriding every one. The tiredness in the mornings. The pressure in my chest when stress hit. The fog by 3pm. The way pants stopped buttoning. The shortness of breath after a flight of stairs. I had explanations for all of it. Sleep. Stress. Age. The work. Something else was always to blame.

Doctors had been telling me too. For years. By the time the numbers climbed to where they were in late 2024, multiple specialists had warned me. I had stopped listening to most of them. Not because I did not believe them. Because the version of life I was running did not have room for what they were asking me to do.

This is what autopilot looks like for a high-functioning man. From the outside, the trajectory tracks. From the inside, you have stopped paying attention to the things that matter most. The body. The mind. The patterns. The questions you used to ask yourself before you got too busy.

What I had missed is that the body was not the problem. The body was the messenger. The actual problem was upstream, in how I was operating, in the way I was running on pressure and calling it discipline, in the patterns I had stopped questioning years earlier. The weight, the bloodwork, the medications, the liver, all of it was downstream of how the inside was running. Trying to fix the body without addressing the inside is what every standard approach gets wrong.

When I finally saw that, the whole approach shifted.

FIVE.

THE RECOGNITION

The rebuild did not begin with a decision. It began with a recognition.

That distinction is more important than it sounds. We tend to think the men who change their lives are the ones with the most willpower, the most discipline, the strongest decision. That is the cultural story, and it does not match what actually happens. The men who change their lives are the ones who finally see what is happening, clearly, without flinching from it. The decision comes second. The decision is the easy part. Seeing is the hard part.

I had been a man who could not see. I had explanations, justifications, rationalizations, and full days organized around not having to look at the underlying thing. Every man stuck in a body, a mind, or a life he does not want has built something similar. It is not weakness. It is what the mind does when it is being asked to live with something painful that it does not yet have a way to address.

The shift, when it came for me, was quiet. There was no rock-bottom moment. There was a series of smaller moments where I stopped overriding what I was actually seeing. The latest doctor's appointment. The photo I caught of myself I did not recognize. The morning where the medications no longer made me feel like a man taking medication. They made me feel like a man being kept alive by them.

You probably have your own version of these moments. The question is whether you are listening to them or overriding them. Because they are happening. The body, the mind, the life are showing you something. The question is just whether you are willing to look.

Write it down. On paper. No phone. No app. Just words on a page. What is your body telling you that you have been overriding? What is your mind telling you that you have stopped listening to? What patterns are running you that you have stopped questioning?

This is not the work yet. This is the precondition to the work. Without seeing clearly, nothing that follows in this guide will hold.

SIX.

WHY STANDARD MOVES DID NOT MOVE IT

If the standard moves worked, none of us would be stuck.

The diet industry, the fitness industry, the productivity industry, the supplement industry, all of it operates on the assumption that the reason men are stuck is that they have not yet found the right plan. Once the right plan arrives, the change will come.

But here is what is actually happening underneath. The plan is not the problem we have. The plan is what we keep reaching for because the actual problem is too uncomfortable to look at. The actual problem is the state we are in that drives the patterns in the first place. The stress, the unprocessed emotion, the patterns we have not examined, the version of life that keeps producing the behaviour the plan then asks us to resist with willpower.

Willpower against pattern is a losing fight, always. The brain is older than the diet plan. The body is older than the calorie tracker. The pattern that has been running for years is older than the resolution you made on Sunday night.

We do not need more willpower. We need a different starting point.

That is the move I want you to understand before we go any further. The lever you have been pulling, the diet lever, the workout lever, the productivity lever, the macros lever, is not the lever that opens the door. The door has a different lever. We are going to spend the rest of this guide on that one.

SEVEN.

THE SHIFT. MIND FIRST.

Here is the principle that did the work. I am going to say it as plainly as I can.

The body follows the mind. The life follows the body. We cannot become a new self while still anchored to the old one.

That is the entire move. Everything else in this guide flows from it.

What it means in practice is that the work begins inside. Before the food. Before the gym. Before any rule about routines or supplements or productivity stacks. The first thing that has to change is the state we are operating in, because the state is what drives every choice we make downstream. As long as the state stays the same, every decision about food, movement, work, and relationships will get pulled back into the old pattern, no matter how disciplined we try to be.

This is not a self-help abstraction. The Stoics wrote about it two thousand years ago. Contemplative traditions across the world have been pointing at it for longer. Modern neuroscience has documented it in detail. The state the mind is in shapes the body it produces, the life it produces, the patterns it produces, far more than the rules we try to impose from the outside.

For me, the shift looked like this. I stopped trying to lose weight or be more productive as goals. The goals had been pulling me in the wrong direction for a decade. Instead, I started doing the work of settling the man underneath. Quieting the noise that was running my days. Sitting with the discomfort I had been numbing with food, screens, pressure. Watching my own thinking the way you would watch weather. Not identifying with it. Just watching it pass.

It gets easier. The first week is the hardest. By the second week, the discomfort starts to ease. By the fourth week, the inner state starts to settle in a way you can feel. By the sixth week, the patterns underneath have started to soften on their own.

What I did was simple. Every morning, before anything else, I sat for ten to twenty minutes. No phone. No input. No music. Just stillness. I let whatever was there come up. The frustration. The fatigue. The thoughts I had been avoiding. I did not try to fix any of it. I just watched.

Then, when the stillness was done, I started the day from that ground instead of from the reactive ground I had been starting from for years. The decisions that followed were different. Because the state was different.

That is the mind first principle in practice. Build the state. The body and the life follow.

If you take only one thing from this guide, take this. The work begins inside. Everything else is downstream.

EIGHT.

WHAT I ACTUALLY DID, DAY TO DAY

The actual practices. The morning protocol. The eating shifts. The movement. The sleep. The reading. The journal. Nothing here is new. The Stoics had a version of all of them. Modern researchers have measured them and confirmed they work. What you are about to read is the recovery of what has been known for thousands of years.

The morning protocol

Every day, in this order, before the phone and before the first input.

Breath. Box breathing. Four counts in, four counts hold, four counts out, four counts hold. Four rounds. This is a hardware intervention. The body's nervous system shifts when the breath rhythm is steady. Cortisol regulates. Heart rate variability improves.

Stillness. Two to ten minutes. Hands on thighs, eyes soft or closed, no movement, no goal. Let thought come and let it go. The capacity to do that for two minutes is the same capacity that holds the line at 6pm when the old pattern wants to fire.

Cold water. Thirty seconds to one minute on face and wrists. A full cold shower if you can handle it. The cold produces a regulated alert state that a warm shower never does.

Movement. Ten pushups. Twenty squats. Or a five-minute walk. Just enough to convert the stillness into readiness.

Twelve to twenty minutes total. The result is a different ground to stand the day on.

Eating

What changed was not a rule. It was the result of the state changing. When the morning protocol was in place, the cravings softened on their own. I did not count calories. I did not follow a plan. I ate real food at proper meals, sitting down, without screens. The shift was eating from a settled state instead of from a reactive one.

Movement, not workouts

Twenty to forty minutes of walking daily, outside, no headphones. Walking is the most underrated practice in modern health. After three months I added some bodyweight movement a few times a week. Not a workout. Just movement.

Sleep

Same time every night. No screens for an hour before. Seven to eight hours. Within two weeks, the body started recovering in ways it had not been able to before.

Reading and reflection

Thirty to forty minutes daily. Old books. Marcus Aurelius. Epictetus. Seneca. The Tao Te Ching. James Allen. Written hundreds or thousands of years ago by men who thought carefully about how to live. Five minutes of honest journaling at night.

The whole protocol takes under two hours a day. No gym. No supplements. No expensive equipment. No coach. No program. The result over sixteen months is documented in the proof section.

Easy does it. One day at a time.

NINE.

WHAT I DID NOT DO

This rebuild was defined as much by what I refused to do as by what I did.

I did not count calories. Never used a tracking app. The act of tracking food turns into another version of the controlling, anxious relationship that drove the patterns in the first place.

I did not follow a plan. No keto, no intermittent fasting protocol, no productivity stack, no diet system. I ate real food, walked, slept. Plain.

I did not join a gym. Walking into a gym at 221 lbs would have reinforced everything I was trying to release.

I did not weigh myself daily. The scale creates anxiety. I wanted to listen to the body, not to a number.

I did not take supplements. The supplement industry is built overwhelmingly on solving problems most men do not actually have.

I did not announce it. No social media posts. No accountability partners. The work is more honest when it is not being performed for anyone else.

The freedom in not doing these things is real. Most of the personal-development industry depends on convincing you that you need their plan, their app, their coach. The honest truth is that the things that actually move the rebuild are free, simple, and have been known for thousands of years.

You can do this from where you are sitting, with what you already own, starting tomorrow morning.

TEN.

THE PACE

The honest timeline.

Month 1

The morning protocol begins. First week is uncomfortable. Sitting still is hard. The cravings are loud. Sleep is rough. By week two, the body starts to settle. Weight down maybe 5 to 8 lbs. The bigger shift is internal.

Months 2 to 3

Walking becomes the anchor. Eating settles. The evening patterns dissolve. Weight down another 8 to 12 lbs. Clothes fit differently. Others start to notice quietly.

Months 4 to 6

Steady phase. No drama. Just daily action. Weight down another 15 to 20 lbs. Bloodwork improves. Doctor starts adjusting medications downward.

Months 7 to 9

Compounding kicks in. Liver bloodwork dramatically improved. Two medications off. Roughly 50 lbs lost from starting weight.

Months 10 to 12

Fibroscan shows liver back to stage 0. Three more medications come off. Bloodwork normal. Weight down to 155 lbs.

Months 13 to 16

Final settling. Stable at 150 lbs. Medications all gone. Cholesterol, triglycerides, blood pressure all in deep normal range. The man I had been at 221 lbs is not the man I am at 150 lbs. The change is not just in the body. It is in how I think, how I show up, how I handle pressure.

Sixteen months of daily, repeatable, sustainable action. The slow version is the only version that lasts.

ELEVEN.

WHERE TO START THIS WEEK

You have read enough.

What separates the men who change from the men who stay stuck is action. So here is what to do this week.

Tomorrow morning

Before the phone. Before email. Wake up. Sit on the edge of your bed for two minutes. Four rounds of box breathing. Ten pushups. Cold water on your face for thirty seconds. Twelve minutes. Tomorrow.

Do it the day after, and the day after that, for seven days.

This week

One twenty-minute walk per day. Outside. No headphones.

One real meal a day, sitting down, no screens. Slowly.

Tonight

Write down the actual state your body is in. Weight, bloodwork numbers if you have them, pants size, energy, sleep, how you feel in your own skin. Be honest.

If you do that, you will know within a week whether this is for you.

Do the thing.

Until then, mind first. The rest follows.

One day at a time.

Taran Aujla

ONTARIO, CANADA